problems unique to Islamic societies … Trigonometry found several areas of application, one of these being the determination of the direction of prayer, i.e. the determination of the direction of Mecca (the *qibla*), for a given locality." But, cf. *infra* in main text.

38. The astronomical thinking of Hanafis and Shafi'is in Samarqand during the eleventh century is known thanks to a text by al-Bazdawi (d. AH 482/1089 CE, of which a seventeenth-century manuscript survives in Cairo): the Shafi'is simply followed the precedent of the Prophet's *qibla* in Medina, which faced south – coincidentally also an auspicious direction in pre-Islamic wind theory, whence the south wind *qabul* (sharing the Arabic root q-b-l with *qibla*) brought rain to the Hijaz. The Hanafis, by contrast, relied on their immediate surroundings as determinants, basing their western *qibla* on the direction of the road from Samarqand to Mecca. See King 1982; King 1995; King 1993.
39. It should be observed that, given Karrami leanings toward Hanafi legal tenets (cf. Zysow 2011/2012: pt v), it is likely that the Karramiyya also adhered to a *qibla* due west (270°). The likelihood is bolstered by the *minar* of Jam, a monument in all probability of Karrami affiliation, which has a *mihrab* on its east face oriented 260°, very close to the Hanafis' western *qibla* ("true" *qibla* at Jam would be 245°). D. Thomas, pers. comm., May 2018; see also *infra* in main text and Chapter 3.
40. King 1992: 254.
41. See Najimi 2015: 154. It is lamentable that the author did not include a photograph of the previously unpublished inscription to aid in seeing its exact location within the epigraphic program of the southern façade, its scale, and its relationship with the façade's other inscriptions. Cf. also Appendix, Afghanistan IV:2.
42. Najimi 2015: 158 (emphasis added); and *ibid.*, 167–168 for a table listing the varying readings of some of the inscriptions. See also Casimir and Glatzer 1971: 56ff.; Glatzer 1972: 50ff.; Blair 1985: 83–86.
43. Casimir and Glatzer 1971.
44. Sourdel-Thomine (2004: 153–154) described in some detail the complexity involved in planning the monumental epigraphic program on the *minar* of Jam (cf. Chapter 3 and *infra* in main text), but also applicable to other sites. The challenges to overcome included the varying lengths of verses, and their placement such that size and script modifications according to space would be virtually unnoticeable. These factors were relevant also in the opening verses of Surat al-Fath: significant differences in length among verses 5–8 make it difficult to surmise how many would have continued on the no longer extant southwestern flank of the façade. Cf. also Ettinghausen 1974: 307–309.
45. Najimi 2015.
46. *Tashriq* refers to the eleventh through the thirteenth days of the month of Dhu al-Hijja, three days after 'Id al-Adha and also the three-day period of the end of the Hajj. It is the time of animal sacrifice, which in essence haptically recalls Abraham's (Ibrahim) willingness to sacrifice his son upon divine command. However, there was apparently no specific *takbir* to be recited during this period, at least according to al-Bukhari's *Sahih.* Cf. at: https://